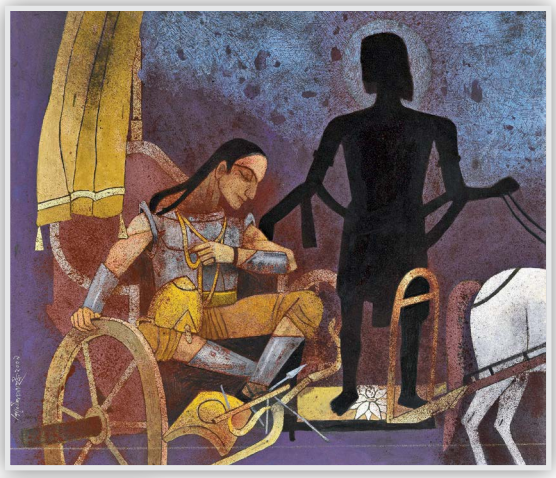




ON DISPLAY (clockwise from left) Works by Arpita Singh, Ganesh Pyne, Sushen Ghosh, Shreyasi Chatterjee and Sanat Kar

ART

CELEBRATING AN ARTY MILESTONE

Kolkata's CIMA art gallery turns 30 and marks the moment with a series of iconic exhibitions, beginning with *12 Masters*





The Kolkata-based CIMA (Center of International Modern Art) is celebrating 30 years of operations with a series of exhibitions that started on December 22 and shall continue over the next six months, until May 25. This first part of the celebrations, an exhibition called *12 Masters*, is currently up at CIMA, Kolkata. The final leg involves a 30th-anniversary-special show called *Fantastic Realities* and *Beyond Exhibition*, which travels to Delhi's Visual Arts Gallery in February before being seen at CIMA, Kolkata, in April.

12 Masters is a successor in spirit to *Visions*, a project that Rakhi Sarkar, director of the CIMA gallery, put together towards the beginning of her career, in 1986. The first phase ('From Fantasy to Subliminal') includes works by four artists—Arpita Singh, Ganesh Pyne, Shreyasi Chatterjee and Sushen Ghosh. In the next phases, works by Jogen Chowdhury, Meera Mukherjee, Sanat Kar, Lalu Prasad Shaw et al will be displayed.



"When you curate, it's essential that you know what kind of story you want to tell"

RAKHI SARKAR
Director, CIMA

"The original *Visions* did not have a female artist in the lineup—Meera Mukherjee's absence made it 'incomplete' in that sense. Also, we were focused on very mainstream activities like painting," says Sarkar. "This time around, we knew we had to cut across gender and medium. It's much more comprehensive since we have excellent examples of graphic art, like the works of Sanat Kar and Lalu Prasad Shaw."

The point about cutting across mediums is highlighted, for example, by the work of Shreyasi Chatterjee. In 'Co-Existence', she creates a powerful, patchwork-like image that speaks of various kinds